During the one hour that she spent at DRDL, she covered wideranging aspects of the IGMDP, from flight system plans to multiple development laboratories. In the end, she addressed the 2000-strong DRDL community. She asked for the schedules of the flight system that we were working on. “When are you going to flight test Prithvi?” Shrimati Gandhi asked. I said, “June 1987.” She immediately responded, “Let me know what is needed to accelerate the flight schedule.” She wanted scientific and technological results fast. “Your fast pace of work is the hope of the entire nation,” she said. She also told me that the emphasis of the IGMDP should be not only on schedule but also on the pursuance of excel ence. “No matter what you achieve, you should never be completely satisfied and should always be searching for ways to prove yourself,” she added. Within a month, she demonstrated her interest and support by sending the newly appointed Defence Minister, SB Chavan, to review our projects. Shrimati Gandhi’s fol ow-up approach was not only impressive, it was effective too. Today, everyone associated with aerospace research in our country knows that excel ence is synonymous with the IGMDP.